

DIPLOMATIC EMERGENCY INSTRUMENT

The Last Resort Emergency Protocol

*A Bare-Minimum Military Freeze and De-escalation Framework
Between the United States and the Islamic Republic of Iran*

Version 1.0 — 27 May 2026

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*"When comprehensive treaties fail, the wise diplomat asks not what can be won,
but what catastrophe can be prevented in the next 72 hours."*

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Preamble: The Edge of the Abyss

As of 27 May 2026, the United States and the Islamic Republic of Iran stand closer to a comprehensive peace agreement than at any point since hostilities began twelve weeks ago—and simultaneously closer to catastrophic escalation. The paradox is real: negotiations are "proceeding in an orderly and constructive manner," in the words of President Trump, even as U.S. Central Command conducts what it describes as "self-defense strikes" against Iranian missile sites and mine-laying vessels in the Strait of Hormuz.

The facts on the ground are these: a ceasefire brokered by Pakistan in early April technically holds but frays daily. U.S. naval forces enforce a blockade on Iranian ports. The Strait of Hormuz remains effectively closed, keeping global oil prices elevated and energy markets volatile. Iran retains approximately 440 kilograms of uranium enriched to 60 percent purity—a short technical step from weapons grade. IAEA inspectors have not visited Iranian nuclear sites since the June 2025 strikes. On 25 May 2026, U.S. forces struck IRGC boats laying mines and a surface-to-air missile site at Bandar Abbas. Iran's Revolutionary Guard claims to have shot down a U.S. MQ-9 Reaper in response.

President Trump has stated that a deal is "largely negotiated" while cautioning negotiators "not to rush." Iranian Foreign Ministry spokesperson Esmail Baghaei has acknowledged "narrowing differences" while warning that "no one can claim" an agreement is imminent. The President has linked any Iran deal to a major expansion of the Abraham Accords, urging Saudi Arabia, Qatar, Egypt, Jordan, Turkey and Pakistan to normalize relations with Israel—a condition Pakistan has already publicly rejected.

This is the landscape in which The Last Resort Emergency Protocol exists. It is not a comprehensive peace treaty. It is not a permanent settlement of the nuclear file, the regional proxy question, or the sanctions architecture. It is something far more modest and far more urgent: a binding, verifiable, auto-renewing mechanism that freezes military escalation, secures the nuclear flashpoint, and reopens the Strait of Hormuz—creating the stable conditions under which comprehensive diplomacy can proceed.

Emergency Context

This Protocol is designed for signature within 72 hours. It requires no legislative ratification. It creates no permanent precedent. It exists solely to prevent the negotiations of late May 2026 from collapsing into renewed full-scale war.

This instrument draws from the operational innovations of the Interim Crisis Prevention Accord v1.0, the Fallback Stabilization Agreement v1.0, the Provisional Steps Framework v1.3, and the Crescent Compact v3.0—but it strips away every element that is not strictly necessary for immediate de-escalation. Where those

frameworks run to hundreds of pages, this Protocol contains only what is essential to stop the guns from firing while diplomats continue their work.

Purpose and Architecture

What This Protocol Does

This Protocol creates a **minimum-viable stabilization zone** between the Parties. It addresses only those issues whose continued deadlock poses immediate risk of catastrophic escalation. All other matters—long-term enrichment rights, permanent facility status, full sanctions architecture, war reparations, ballistic missiles, regional proxy arrangements, Abraham Accords linkage—are explicitly deferred to comprehensive negotiations to be conducted during or after the interim period.

What This Protocol Does Not Do

- It does not permanently resolve Iran's nuclear program
- It does not require Iran to dismantle any centrifuge or facility
- It does not lift sanctions beyond targeted humanitarian and economic confidence measures
- It does not address Lebanon, Yemen, Iraq, Syria, or proxy arrangements
- It does not require either Party to alter its diplomatic relationships
- It does not link to the Abraham Accords or regional normalization
- It does not require either Party to describe the agreement using any particular terminology

No-Precedent Clause (Operative and Binding)

This Protocol establishes no legal or political precedent for any future negotiation. Each provision is tailored to the emergency circumstances of May 2026. No inference may be drawn regarding positions on any matter not expressly addressed herein. The unique maritime coordination mechanisms apply exclusively to the Strait of Hormuz during the operational lifespan of this Protocol.

Core Operating Principles

All provisions of this Protocol are governed by three principles:

PRINCIPLE I: SYNCHRONIZED RECIPROCAL MOTION

Neither Party moves alone. Every Iranian commitment triggers a corresponding U.S. commitment on the same clock cycle. Verification is shared. Both governments can defend the sequencing as responding only when the other has moved first or simultaneously. If one side stops, the other stops. This eliminates the "who moves first" trap that has collapsed every previous negotiation.

PRINCIPLE II: TELEMETRY-FIRST VERIFICATION

Every commitment must be expressible as a sensor reading, a data feed, a physical lock confirmation, or a financial transaction record. If it cannot be verified by a neutral technical system, it does not belong in the operational text. The verification architecture is deliberately minimal: IAEA for nuclear, Oman for maritime, Swiss escrow for financial. No complex institutional hierarchy. No voting bodies. No weighted breach indices.

PRINCIPLE III: ROLLBACK, NOT COLLAPSE

If either Party breaches, the Protocol does not terminate. It pauses in graduated tiers: discretionary measures halt first, core constraints survive longest, and humanitarian protections remain in force regardless. Ambiguity triggers investigation, not punishment. Only deliberate, verified, hostile violations trigger full review—and even then, military response is not embedded in the Protocol. Breach does not equal war. It equals structured review and diplomatic re-engagement.

Article I: The 72-Hour Auto-Renewing Military Freeze

1.1 Simultaneous Operational Freeze

Upon signature of this Protocol, both Parties shall immediately implement a legally binding cessation of offensive military operations:

- **The United States shall suspend:** all offensive airstrikes, naval bombardment, and blockade enforcement actions against Iranian targets; all offensive cyber operations against Iranian nuclear monitoring systems, banking infrastructure, and maritime navigation systems; and shall transition naval forces to a stand-off posture maintaining a minimum 5-nautical-mile distance from the Strait of Hormuz transit corridor centerline.

- **The Islamic Republic of Iran shall suspend:** all offensive military operations against U.S. forces and interests, including proxy kinetic actions; all enrichment activity above 3.67 percent U-235; all mine-laying, naval interdiction, and harassment operations in the Strait of Hormuz; and all offensive cyber operations against U.S. critical infrastructure.

1.2 The Auto-Renewing Mechanism

The military freeze operates as a **self-renewing 72-hour module**. If both Parties confirm compliance at Hour 71 through the Joint Hotline, the module automatically renews for another 72 hours. This mechanism continues indefinitely until either Party provides 48 hours' written notice of non-renewal to the Facilitating State, or until the Protocol is superseded by a comprehensive agreement.

WHY THIS WORKS

Separating the ceasefire clock (72-hour loops) from the implementation clock (30-day phases) neutralizes the "negotiation about negotiation" trap. If comprehensive talks stall on Day 14 over implementation details, the guns do not automatically resume firing. The 72-hour military freeze continues auto-renewing quietly in the background, creating the stability necessary for diplomacy to proceed without the constant threat of reversion to open hostilities.

1.3 Verification of the Freeze

PARTY		VERIFICATION METHOD	VERIFIER		WINDOW
Iran	(enrichment freeze)	Online Enrichment Monitors (OLEM) + real-time camera feeds at Natanz and Fordow	IAEA		Immediate
Iran (naval/military)		AIS vessel tracking + satellite thermal imaging + Omani naval observation	Oman		3-7 days
U.S. (naval posture)		AIS tracking of U.S. naval positions + Omani naval observation	Oman		3-7 days
U.S.	(no new sanctions)	OFAC database monitoring	Swiss agent	escrow	7 days

The 72-hour clock starts on IAEA confirmation of enrichment freeze, not physical arrival of inspectors. U.S. operational compliance begins upon signature and is verified by Omani naval observers and Lloyd's List AIS tracking.

1.4 The Attribution Firewall

If a regional proxy strike occurs during the freeze, **neither Party may unilaterally declare a material breach**. The Facilitating State has 48 hours to conduct forensic assessment and attribute the incident. During this window, the 72-hour military freeze remains active. Only the Facilitating State's attribution finding can trigger tier escalation. Rogue actors, false-flag operations, and incidents resulting in fewer than 10 casualties are excluded from bilateral penalties.

This firewall exists because both Parties have limited control over proxy actors, and because the history of U.S.-Iran negotiations is littered with deals collapsed by third-party spoilers. What happens in Lebanon, Yemen, or Gaza stays in those theaters. It cannot blow back onto the core U.S.-Iran military freeze.

Article II: Nuclear Flashpoint Resolution

2.1 The HEU Custody Compromise

President Trump has demanded physical control of Iran's approximately 400 kg of highly enriched uranium. Iran has declared, as a binding sovereign position, that its enriched uranium must remain under Iranian legal title and within Iranian territory during any verification period. This Protocol creates a third path that satisfies both Parties' essential requirements:

THE OMAN ESCROW SOLUTION

The entire stockpile of uranium enriched to 60 percent U-235 and above shall be consolidated, inventoried, and transported to an **IAEA-monitored escrow facility in Muscat, Oman**—not the United States—within 14 days of Protocol activation. The Central Bank of Iran retains full sovereign legal title to the HEU at all times. The IAEA holds physical custody only. The Sultanate of Oman serves as the escrow guarantor state.

What President Trump gains: Every gram of Iran's HEU stockpile is located, sealed, under international control, and physically outside Iranian territory. U.S. technical personnel receive real-time monitoring access

via encrypted telemetry. Consolidation to one facility eliminates the risk of hidden breakout material. The material cannot be weaponized without detection.

What Iran retains: The HEU never enters U.S. custody. Legal title remains with the Central Bank of Iran. The IAEA may not transfer, sell, or dispose of the material without written consent. Iranian observers accompany every stage of packaging and transit. A friendly Islamic state (Oman) hosts the material. Iran can frame this as placing its material in international trust, not delivering it to an adversary.

2.2 Enrichment Freeze

Concurrent with HEU consolidation, Iran shall halt all enrichment above 3.67 percent U-235 effective immediately upon signature. This is a 30-day freeze, not a permanent ban. No centrifuge is destroyed. No facility is dismantled. The freeze is verified by Online Enrichment Monitors (OLEM) and confirmed by IAEA on-site inspectors within 7 days.

Iran retains the right to enrich uranium to 3.67 percent at Natanz for civilian purposes. All enrichment infrastructure above 3.67 percent is placed under IAEA seal with continuous camera monitoring. Fordow and all non-Natanz facilities are placed in non-operational status under seal.

2.3 Verification Timeline

PHASE	CLOCK TIME	ACTION	VERIFIER
T+0	Day 1	Protocol activates; enrichment freeze begins	OLEM (immediate)
T+12h	Day 1	IAEA inspectors arrive; begin physical inventory of HEU	IAEA
T+24h	Day 2	Inventory complete; mass spectrometry confirms isotopic composition	IAEA
T+48h	Day 3	Cylinders loaded into IAEA-certified secure casks; tamper-evident seals applied	IAEA
T+7d	Day 7	Convoy departs for Oman under armed IAEA guard; continuous satellite surveillance	IAEA + Oman

T+14d Day 14 HEU placed in IAEA custody at Muscat escrow facility; dual-lock custody initiated IAEA + Oman

The 14-day timeline may be extended by up to 7 additional days upon request through the Facilitating State if verified administrative, technical, or logistical constraints arise. Such delays do not constitute breach.

Article III: Strait of Hormuz Emergency Reopening

3.1 Emergency Joint Transit Coordination

Within 72 hours of Protocol signature, a provisional **Joint Transit Coordination Cell (JTCC)** shall be established at Bandar Abbas (Iranian side) and Khasab (Omani side), staffed by personnel from Iran, the United States, and Oman. The JTCC does not stop, board, or search vessels. Its function is purely coordinative: monitor AIS data, coordinate patrol schedules, respond to distress calls, and ensure uninterrupted commercial transit.

3.2 The PGSA Recognition Compromise

The Persian Gulf Strait Authority (PGSA), established by Iran on 5 May 2026, is recognized as the designated Iranian operational body for transit coordination within Iranian territorial waters for the duration of this Protocol. This Protocol does not confer or withhold international legal status upon the PGSA. It simply treats the Authority as the existing operational entity through which transit coordination occurs. All PGSA transit permits bear dual branding: PGSA-Iran (domestic) and JTCC-Authorized (international).

3.3 No Unilateral Tolls

During the 30-day interim period, no transit fees or tolls shall be collected by any Party. This addresses President Trump's explicit demand: "We don't want tolls." The cost of JTCC operations shall be borne by a neutral Multilateral Maritime Maintenance Fund established under Article IV, not by vessel operators.

3.4 Synchronized Naval Posture

Both Parties shall maintain a symmetrical 5-nautical-mile stand-off distance from the Strait transit corridor during the interim period. Neither Party shall conduct provocative naval maneuvers, boarding operations, or interdiction actions within the transit corridor. Patrol coordination schedules shall be published weekly to all JTCC members.

3.5 What Each Party Gains

For President Trump: The Strait is open. Tolls are suspended. American and allied vessels transit without interference. U.S. naval forces operate with clear rules of engagement. Global energy flows resume, stabilizing oil markets and U.S. gasoline prices.

For Iran: The PGSA is acknowledged as the operational coordination body. Iranian personnel staff the Bandar Abbas coordination center. Iran's sovereignty over adjacent territorial waters is not challenged. The principle of Iranian involvement in Strait governance is recognized. Iranian oil exports can resume through the reopened waterway.

Article IV: Humanitarian and Economic Release Valve

4.1 Immediate Humanitarian Release (Day 1)

Upon signature of this Protocol and concurrent activation of the military freeze, the United States shall authorize the release of **\$250 million via Swiss escrow** for immediate humanitarian purposes: medicine, food, medical equipment, and agricultural inputs. This release is not contingent on IAEA verification. It is contingent solely on simultaneous activation of the military freeze by both Parties. This is Day-One relief for the Iranian population.

4.2 Humanitarian Firewall

The humanitarian channel is **legally non-divertible and inviolable**. It continues regardless of any dispute, breach, or suspension of other Protocol provisions. The UN OCHA/WHO administrator holds sole disbursement authority. Any attempt to redirect, condition, or delay humanitarian funds triggers automatic IAEA investigation but does not affect the humanitarian flow itself. Medicine, food, and medical equipment flows continue even if all other provisions collapse.

4.3 Economic Confidence Measures (Day 7)

Within 7 days of verified HEU consolidation beginning (Article II), the United States shall:

1. Issue an OFAC general license authorizing the sale of civilian aircraft spare parts to Iran for 30 days;

2. Permit the export of agricultural goods and medical equipment under existing humanitarian exemptions without additional licensing requirements;
3. Freeze all new sanctions designations for the duration of the Protocol.

4.4 Frozen Asset Release (Day 14)

Upon IAEA confirmation that HEU has been placed in Oman escrow custody, **25 percent of frozen Iranian assets** shall be released to Iranian control via the Central Bank of Oman as escrow agent. The remaining 75 percent remains held pending comprehensive negotiation. This is a 25/75 split that partially addresses both Parties' positions: Iran receives immediate, tangible economic benefit; the United States retains the majority of leverage for the comprehensive deal.

4.5 Iran's Reciprocal Commitments

In synchronized motion, Iran shall:

1. Permit unrestricted humanitarian vessel transit through the Strait of Hormuz at zero cost;
2. Not interfere with the operations of humanitarian organizations (UN, ICRC, WHO) in Iranian waters or airspace;
3. Cooperate with JTCC coordination functions and publish weekly patrol schedules.

Article V: Minimum Viable Verification

5.1 Design Philosophy

Previous frameworks created elaborate institutional architectures: Joint Commissions, subcommittees, working groups, weighted breach indices, and complex voting procedures. This Protocol creates three bodies. That is all. Each has one job, reports directly to both Parties, and publishes findings to a shared digital dashboard.

BODY	LOCATION	FUNCTION	STAFF
Joint Hotline	Muscat, Oman	24/7 communication between senior U.S. and Iranian officials; compliance confirmation; crisis response	Omani duty officers (3 per shift)

Shared Dashboard	Hosted by Switzerland; mirrored in Oman	Publishes real-time data on verification, compliance, asset transfers, and naval posture	Neutral IT team (4 people)
Facilitator's Office	Geneva (primary); Muscat (maritime backup)	Manages escrow, convenes mediation, publishes compliance reports	Neutral diplomatic staff (6 people)

5.2 Five-Channel Verification

Compliance is verified through five independent channels. No single channel's report is determinative. Convergence of at least three channels is required for any compliance determination:

1. **IAEA Technical Verification:** On-site inspectors, OLEM sensors, mass spectrometry, camera feeds
2. **Neutral-State Naval Observation:** Omani naval observers log positions and movements of both Parties' forces
3. **Commercial AIS/Satellite Tracking:** Lloyd's List and independent maritime monitors confirm Hormuz transit volumes
4. **Financial Escrow Verification:** Swiss Financial Cell confirms asset transfers and humanitarian disbursements
5. **Joint Hotline Assessment:** Daily operational reporting from both Parties through the Muscat channel

5.3 Three-Tier Breach Response

TIER	TRIGGER	RESPONSE	WHAT SURVIVES
Tier 1: Technical Fix	Minor procedural deviation; delayed reporting; telemetry anomaly	7-day remediation. Enhanced monitoring. No consequences.	All provisions continue.
Tier 2: Discretionary Pause	Significant operational non-compliance: enrichment above 3.67% detected; unauthorized HEU access attempt	Next economic tranche held. 14-day remediation window opens. Non-humanitarian benefits may pause.	Humanitarian channel. Military freeze. Enrichment cap monitoring. Hotline.

Tier	3:	Deliberate hostile violation: All pending benefits frozen. Pre- Humanitarian corridor under UN
Full	resumption of enrichment Protocol sanctions posture mandate. IAEA baseline monitoring.	
Review	above 60%; kinetic attack on the resumes. Reconstitution Ceasefire hotline active for 180 days.	
	other Party; removal of IAEA conference convened within 14 HEU remains in IAEA custody.	
	seals	days.

Key Design Feature

Only deliberate, verified, hostile violations reach Tier 3. Ambiguity, technical glitches, and administrative delays are Tier 1. No military authorization is embedded in any tier. Breach does not equal war.

Article VI: Dispute Resolution and Cooling-Off

6.1 Mandatory Cooling-Off Period

If disagreement occurs and attribution is unclear, **all escalation freezes automatically** for a mandatory 24-to-72-hour Cooling-Off Period. Neither Party may take escalatory military action during this period. The Facilitating State investigates and recommends resolution within 72 hours. This cooling-off is automatic—it does not require either Party to request it. It activates upon any Tier 2 or Tier 3 trigger.

6.2 Rapid Consultation

Any Party may request emergency consultation within 4 hours of any perceived violation. The other Party shall respond within 12 hours. Consultation occurs through the Joint Hotline in Muscat or via the Facilitator's Office in Geneva.

6.3 Neutral Mediation

If direct consultation fails to resolve the dispute within 48 hours, the neutral chair of the Facilitator's Office (or the UN Secretary-General's representative) shall mediate. Mediation is non-binding but its recommendations are published and carry significant political weight.

6.4 No Unilateral Military Response

Neither Party shall undertake military action in response to a perceived breach without first exhausting the dispute resolution procedures in this Article, except in the case of verified imminent armed attack under UN Charter Article 51. Premature military response forfeits the responding Party's next scheduled benefit tranche.

6.5 Reconstitution Commitment

If the Protocol enters full suspension, both Parties commit to attend a **Reconstitution Conference within 14 days**, hosted by the Facilitating State, to attempt restoration of the minimum viable core: military freeze, humanitarian corridor, and IAEA baseline monitoring.

Article VII: Duration, Exit and Graduation

7.1 30-Day Initial Duration

This Protocol enters into force upon signature and remains in force for an initial period of 30 days. It may be extended by mutual written consent of both Parties for additional 30-day periods without limit. Extension by silence: if neither Party provides written notice of non-extension at least 48 hours before expiration, the Protocol automatically renews for another 30 days.

7.2 Graduation Pathway

The express purpose of this Protocol is to create the stable conditions necessary for comprehensive peace negotiations. Within 14 days of signature, both Parties commit to commence good-faith comprehensive negotiations toward a permanent agreement addressing all outstanding issues: long-term enrichment parameters, permanent facility status, full sanctions relief architecture, regional security arrangements, and all other matters deferred by this Protocol.

7.3 Minimum Viable Core

Under all circumstances, including total Protocol suspension, three elements survive:

1. The military-to-military hotline remains active for 180 days;

2. The humanitarian corridor through Hormuz continues at zero cost under UN mandate;
3. The emergency diplomatic channel stays open for 180 days;
4. HEU remains in IAEA custody at the Oman escrow facility pending further negotiation.

7.4 Exit Provisions

Either Party may withdraw from this Protocol with 72 hours' written notice to the Facilitating State and the other Party. Withdrawal does not trigger automatic resumption of hostilities. The 72-hour auto-renewing ceasefire module continues until its natural expiration unless explicitly non-renewed. HEU remains in IAEA custody for 30 days following withdrawal, after which return procedures are negotiated.

7.5 Supersession

This Protocol is automatically superseded upon entry into force of any comprehensive agreement between the Parties. All escrowed materials, ongoing verification activities, and institutional arrangements transition seamlessly into the successor framework unless otherwise agreed.

Article VIII: Optional Israel-Lebanon-Hezbollah Military Freeze (Annex)

Optional Annex — Not Required for Core Protocol Entry into Force

This Article is an **optional annex** that may be activated by mutual written consent of the United States, the Islamic Republic of Iran, and the State of Israel within 72 hours of Core Protocol signature. It does not form part of the mandatory obligations under Articles I through VII. Its sole purpose is to prevent escalation on the Israel-Lebanon front from collapsing the core U.S.-Iran de-escalation framework. If this Annex is not activated, the Core Protocol remains fully operative without it.

8.1 Dossier Isolation Firewall

The most dangerous structural vulnerability in any U.S.-Iran agreement is the risk that a Hezbollah strike into northern Israel or an Israeli air strike on a Hezbollah position in southern Lebanon triggers a chain reaction that collapses the core nuclear and maritime deal. This Annex creates a **binding structural firewall** that

explicitly prohibits either the United States or Iran from using incidents, friction, or localized military activity in southern Lebanon as justification for suspending or collapsing Articles I through VII of this Protocol.

Operative Principle: The Lebanon file and the U.S.-Iran nuclear/maritime file are legally and operationally segregated. What happens in Lebanon stays in Lebanon — it cannot blow back onto Hormuz.

8.2 The 10-Casualty Threshold

The Core Protocol (Article I.4) establishes that incidents resulting in fewer than 10 casualties are excluded from bilateral penalties between the United States and Iran. This Annex extends that principle to the Israel-Lebanon front:

TRIGGER CATEGORY	LEBANON IMPACT	CORE PROTOCOL IMPACT
Hezbollah rocket fire into Israel (below 10 casualties)	Israeli defensive response; regional de-escalation channel	NONE — Core Protocol unaffected
Israeli air strike on Hezbollah position (below 10 casualties)	UNIFIL coordination; ICRC monitoring	NONE — Core Protocol unaffected
Ground incursion or major escalation (above 10 casualties)	Major emergency session; UNSC consultation	NONE — stepback prohibited by Firewall
Iranian weapons transfer to Hezbollah (verified)	SEAC attribution; regional monitoring	NONE — isolated to Lebanon track

8.3 Hezbollah Operational Pause

If this Annex is activated, Iran commits to transmit immediate, formal instructions to Hezbollah leadership for a structured, time-limited operational de-escalation concurrent with the Core Protocol timeline. This is not disarmament, surrender, or political concession:

PHASE	DURATION	HEZBOLLAH PARAMETERS	ISRAELI RECIPROCAL
Phase 1	Days 1–30	Cessation of cross-border rocket and drone attacks; defensive positions only; no new weapons transfers from Iran	Suspension of offensive air strikes against Hezbollah positions for 30 days; IDF maintains defensive posture only

Phase	Days	Continued cessation of offensive operations; forces remain in defensive positions; no infiltration across the Blue Line	Extension of air strike moratorium contingent on 90 days verified Hezbollah restraint
2	31–90		
Phase	Days	Exploration of structured de-escalation through parallel diplomatic track; political and humanitarian engagement permitted	Israeli restrictions reviewed at Day 180 milestone; further confidence-building measures considered
3	91–180		

8.4 Verification Architecture

The Hezbollah operational pause is verified through four independent channels: (1) **UNIFIL ground patrols** — daily patrols along the Blue Line with incident logging; (2) **Israeli intelligence assessment** — weekly classified brief with sanitized summary; (3) **Lebanese Armed Forces liaison** — daily reporting from LAF command to the Oman Liaison Office; (4) **SEAC pattern analysis** — automated detection of supply route activity and weapons convoy movement. All four channels must show compliance before the pause is considered verified.

8.5 Non-Compliance Consequences (Isolated to Lebanon Track)

If any channel reports significant Hezbollah offensive action: (1) 24-hour verification window — all four channels confirm; (2) if confirmed, Iran has 72 hours to transmit renewed de-escalation instructions through the Oman back-channel; (3) if Iran de-escalates within 72 hours, pause resumes with enhanced monitoring; (4) if Iran does not de-escalate, Israel may resume defensive air strikes limited to specific positions involved — not blanket escalation; (5) **under no circumstances does a Hezbollah incident trigger suspension of Core Protocol Articles I through VII.**

8.6 Parallel Diplomatic Track

This Annex creates a **Levant Regional Basket** — a parallel diplomatic track, separate from the Core Protocol, for long-term Israel-Lebanon stability. The Basket addresses: Blue Line demarcation, Shebaa Farms status, Lebanese territorial sovereignty, and civilian protection architecture. It operates through Oman-facilitated consultations with participation from Lebanon, Israel, the Palestinian Authority, and the United Nations. Progress in the Regional Basket is desirable but not linked to Core Protocol compliance.

8.7 What This Annex Accomplishes

For the United States: The core U.S.-Iran deal is protected from being blown up by a proxy incident in Lebanon. Israel receives immediate security benefits from Day 1 (Hezbollah operational pause). The firewall prevents Tehran's "end the war on all fronts" demand from collapsing the nuclear deal.

For Iran: Iran demonstrates good faith by using its influence to de-escalate the most dangerous regional flashpoint. The operational pause is not disarmament or political concession — it is a structured, time-limited military de-escalation. Iran's support for Lebanese sovereignty is preserved through the Regional Basket.

For Israel: Immediate reduction in cross-border attacks. Formalized 10-casualty threshold provides clarity on what triggers escalation. Direct channel to address Iranian weapons transfers to Hezbollah. Air strike moratorium is contingent and reversible.

Annex A: 72-Hour Implementation Timeline

TIME	IRANIAN ACTION	U.S. ACTION	VERIFICATION
Hour 0	Sign Protocol; activate enrichment freeze above 3.67%; begin HEU inventory	Sign Protocol; suspend offensive operations; release \$250M humanitarian tranche; freeze new sanctions	OLEM confirms freeze; Swiss escrow confirms transfer
Hour 12	IAEA inspectors arrive; physical inventory begins	Naval forces begin transition to stand-off posture	IAEA presence confirmed
Hour 24	Inventory complete; mass spectrometry confirms isotopic composition	OFAC general license for civilian aircraft parts (30 days)	IAEA confirms composition
Hour 48	Cylinders loaded into casks; tamper-evident seals applied; IRGC fast-attack craft withdraw to 5nm anchorage	Exempt humanitarian vessels from blockade enforcement	IAEA confirms seals; Omani naval observers confirm withdrawal
Hour 72	Dual-lock custody operational at declared facility; all enrichment above 3.67% frozen; JTCC established at Bandar Abbas	Naval stand-off complete; blockade reduced 50% for non-military cargo; Joint Hotline fully operational	Joint Hotline certifies Day-One compliance; JTCC operational

Day 7	Convoy departs for Oman under armed IAEA guard; HEU in transit	Tranche 1 asset release (25% of frozen assets); agricultural/medical export licenses streamlined	IAEA confirms convoy; Swiss escrow confirms transfer; satellite tracking active
Day 14	HEU placed in IAEA custody at Muscat escrow facility; Fordow sealed; non-Natanz enrichment under IAEA seal	Comprehensive negotiation talks commence; all blockade restrictions lifted for non-military cargo	IAEA confirms Oman custody; IAEA certifies facility seals
Day 30	Continued clean compliance; Hormuz transit volumes at pre-crisis levels	Decision point: extend, deepen, or conclude	IAEA 30-day compliance report; Lloyd's List confirms transit

Annex B: Domestic Narrative Guidance

Each Party requires a domestically defensible narrative. The following are factually accurate characterizations that both Parties may use without contradiction:

For the United States

- **"Weapons-grade uranium secured."** Iran's entire HEU stockpile is under international lock and key in Oman, with U.S. monitoring access via encrypted telemetry.
- **"Single enrichment facility."** Iran operates only one enrichment facility (Natanz) at 3.67%. Fordow is under IAEA seal.
- **"Hormuz is open, tolls are suspended."** Global energy flows resume without Iranian extortion.
- **"75% of assets held in reserve."** Iran receives only 25% as an initial tranche. The rest remains held for the comprehensive deal.
- **"No reparations paid."** All releases are performance-gated, not liability-based.
- **"We didn't move alone."** Every U.S. concession was matched by simultaneous, verified Iranian action.
- **"Military options preserved."** This is a 30-day emergency freeze, not a permanent commitment. All military options remain on the table.

For Iran

- **"Sovereignty preserved."** The HEU never entered U.S. custody. It remains legally Iranian property, held in IAEA trust in a friendly Islamic state.
- **"NPT rights intact."** Enrichment to 3.67% continues. The limitation is interim, not surrender. No facility was destroyed.
- **"PGSA recognized."** Iran's Strait Authority is acknowledged as the operational coordination body for Hormuz transit.
- **"Blockade lifted."** U.S. offensive operations cease. Ports reopen. Oil exports can resume.
- **"Assets returning."** 25% of frozen sovereign property released within 14 days, with a pathway to more in comprehensive talks.
- **"We moved as equals."** Every Iranian step was matched by simultaneous U.S. action. Oman, not America, guards the material.
- **"Comprehensive deal still possible."** This emergency freeze preserves all positions for the permanent negotiation. Nothing is surrendered.

Shared Message

Both Parties may truthfully state: *"We signed an emergency agreement that prevents war, secures the nuclear flashpoint, opens global energy flows, and delivers immediate humanitarian relief—while preserving all positions for the comprehensive negotiation."*

Instruments of Acceptance

Entry into Force

This Protocol enters into force immediately upon signature by the authorized representatives of both Parties. No domestic legislative approval is required for the initial 30-day period. The Protocol is deposited with the UN Secretary-General upon signature and constitutes a binding international commitment.

Signatures

In witness whereof, the undersigned, being duly authorized by their respective governments, have signed this Last Resort Emergency Protocol.

For the United States of America:

Name: _____

Title: _____

Date: _____

Place: _____

For the Islamic Republic of Iran:

Name: _____

Title: _____

Date: _____

Place: _____

Witness (Facilitating State):

Name: _____

Title: Sultanate of Oman / Swiss Confederation / Islamic Republic of Pakistan

Date: _____

Witness (International Organization):

Name: _____

Title: IAEA Director-General / UN Under-Secretary-General

Date: _____